IT Security Policy

Tallowmere Outfitters | IT and Security | Effective February 3, 2025

Purpose and scope

This policy protects customer, employee and company information. It applies to everyone who uses company systems or data, including contractors, on any device.

Passwords

Use a passphrase of at least 14 characters for every work account, and never reuse a work password anywhere else. Passwords do not expire on a schedule; change yours right away if you think someone else may know it. Your last 10 passwords cannot be reused.

Password manager

Store work passwords in Lockbox, the company password manager. Do not keep passwords in browsers, documents or notes.

Multi-factor authentication

Multi-factor authentication is required for email, the Waypoint HR portal, the VPN and every administrator account, including point-of-sale administration. Use the authenticator app or a hardware security key. Text message codes are not allowed, because they can be intercepted.

Laptops and phones

- Company laptops have full-disk encryption, which must stay on.
- Screens lock automatically after 5 minutes without activity; lock yours whenever you step away.
- Install operating system updates within 14 days of release, and critical security patches within 72 hours.
- You can read work email on a personal phone only through the managed email app.

Lost or stolen devices

Report a lost or stolen laptop, phone or security key to the IT Help Desk within 1 hour of noticing, at any time of day. IT can lock and erase the device remotely.

Phishing

Report suspicious emails with the Report Phishing button in your email. Never sign in through a link in an email; go to the site directly instead. If you clicked a link or entered your password, tell IT immediately. Nobody gets in trouble for reporting a mistake.

Payment card data

Card numbers are entered only into the point-of-sale system or the website checkout. Never write down, photograph, email or store a customer's card number anywhere.

Removable media

USB storage devices are blocked on company laptops. IT can issue an encrypted USB drive when there is a business need.

Training

Everyone completes security awareness training every year. New employees complete it as part of onboarding.

Reporting security incidents

Report anything that might be a security incident to security@tallowmere.example or to the security on-call phone at extension 4911, which is answered 24 hours a day.

Breaking this policy

Breaking this policy can lead to loss of system access and to disciplinary action, up to and including termination.